

The following is a faithful transcription of typed notes by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

A MILLION-DOLLAR PROPOSITION: (NO. I)

HOPE, THE SOUL OF TERRESTRIAL HAPPINESS: DESPAIR?

? LORD SAVE US! A FORETASTE OF HELL.

"KNOW THE TRUTH AND THE TRUTH WILL MAKE YOU FREE."

For the best popular definition and contrasting of two Extremes of most fundamental importance - RELIGION, the "UNRECOGNIZED SCIENCE": AND ATHEISM, THE CLIMAX OF INTELLECTUAL INSANITY AND OF MORAL DEPRAVITY: we shall offer a million-dollar prize; - said definitions, etc, not to exceed fifteen hundred words and to avoid undue reference to any particular system, or denomination. Who "we" are to make such an offer will follow shortly. For the present let it suffice to say that though the writer can hardly claim a red copper as his own; he is nevertheless confident that this proposition is so timely, so urgent just now and so opportune; that, though he know there are individuals, both Christian and Jewish - possibly Pagans too - who would be happy to donate the whole million at once; he would prefer not to accept such an offer. He feels rather that a convention of some kind should be called without delay: - say of reverend clergy and God-fearing lay editors under perhaps a chosen committee of bishops, and rabbis who are known for their faith in God and earnestness to promote human peace on earth and save immortal souls.

Incidentally, it was only about eight or ten years back that a Reverend Rabbi R. - God bless him - came to consult a Christian clergiman; lamenting the threatening growth of atheism among the rising generation, notably among the Jewish denomination. Without one word the latter wrote on a piece of tissue-paper just at hand: "If there's anything of good to come from atheism - in itself the climax of insanity - it is this; It is going to force all those together and ... to harmony, who honestly and gratefully believe in almighty God." At this Rabbi R. who had been steadying the corner of said tissue exclaimed as he struck the desk: "That's inspiration!" Atheism has been becoming more and more threatening ever since till now - especially since the appalling scandal of our honorable Supreme Court last year; for since that unfortunate quasie approval, it has advanced by leaps and bounds, till red Russian atheism seems just waiting for a chance to take over in place of religion, that of course would mean of every system of religion in America as well as in the Soviet countries, for the final aim of atheism has ever been --- every thought of belief and faith in God and the supernatural.

(Unfinished draft)